sideration determine how much of the complaint against it in that regard is true. Now we may confine ourselves to the more specific contention that it discriminates between fire insurance corporations or companies and those engaged in other kinds of insurance.

It is not necessary to state the reasoning upon which classification by legislation is based or justified. This court has had many occasions to do so, and only lately reviewed the subject in *Magoun* v. *Illinois Trust and Savings Bank*, 170 U. S. 283. We said in that case that "the State may distinguish, select and classify objects of legislation, and necessarily the power must have a wide range of discretion." And this because of the function of legislation and the purposes to which it is addressed. Classification for such purposes is not invalid because not depending on scientific or marked differences in things or persons or in their relations. It suffices if it is practical, and is not reviewable unless palpably arbitrary. The classification of the Missouri statute is certainly not arbitrary. We see many differences between fire insurance and other insurance, both to the insurer and the insured — differences in the elements insured against and the possible relation of the parties to them, producing consequences which may justify if not demand different legislative treatment. Of course it is not for us to debate the policy of any particular treatment, and the freedom of discretion which we have said the State has is exhibited by analogous if not exact examples to the Missouri statute in *Railway Company* v. *Mackey*, 127 U. S. 204, 208, and in *Minneapolis & St. Louis Railway* v. *Beckwith*, 129 U. S. 26.

In *Railway Company* v. *Mackey*, 127 U. S. 204, a law of Kansas was passed which abrogated as to railroads the rule of the common law exempting masters from liability to one servant for the negligence of another. It was sustained as a valid classification, notwithstanding that it did not apply to other carriers, or even to other corporations using steam. The law was objected to, as the statute of Missouri is objected to, on the ground that it violated the provisions of the constitution which we are now considering.